

My choices, my voice

Tuesday, September 15, 2026 · Complete content prototype · pedagogical review pending

DAILY GUIDE	TEACHING METHOD	CHILD MATERIALS
Time + sequence	Eight fully written blocks	Cards, 2 child pages, 4-page story

Learning targets

- 01 Choose or name one activity I enjoy, and listen when another child shares a different choice.
- 02 Count 1–5 blocks by touching each block once; describe what I made.
- 03 Recall one thing a story character did when a first attempt did not work.

Today at a glance

TIME	BLOCK / ROUTINE	TEACHER CUE
9:00–9:30	Arrival & Socializing	Outdoor welcome; children choose how to join play.
9:30–9:40	P.E.	Movement sequence; 8–10 minutes within the outdoor morning.
9:40–10:00	Outdoor choice & transition	Free play, clean up, handwashing.
10:00–10:20	Snack & roll call	Operational time from Blue DOT.
10:20–10:40	Large Circle	The five choice cards: read, build, draw, move, or something else.
10:40–10:55	Practice / Small Group	Circle a choice and draw it on the child page.
10:55–11:10	STEM within Practice	Build with up to five blocks; count by touching each one.
11:10–11:15	Reset	Collect pages and put the materials away.
11:15–12:15	Centers & free play	Building, books, group games; teacher observes choices.
12:15–12:40	Lunch	Operational time from Blue DOT.
12:40–13:00	Book Time · before nap	Read the original four-page story, then settle for rest.
13:00–15:30	Nap & wake-up	Nap supervision and the 15:00–15:30 wake-up routine.
15:30–15:34	Book Time · story revisit	Short proposed revisit within the combined afternoon block.
15:34–15:42	Review / Small Circle	Remember the story and compare choices respectfully.
15:42–15:58	Art / Craft	Draw a self-portrait doing a chosen activity; add a badge.
15:58–16:00	Reset	Display or file art; clean up.
16:00–16:20	Snack & hygiene	Operational time from Blue DOT.
16:20–16:40	Closing Circle & outdoor preparation	One thing I tried today; prepare for pickup.

The minute-by-minute splits inside Blue DOT windows are proposed for this example. The after-nap book revisit is four minutes within the 15:30–16:00 combined block.

Arrival to Large Circle

01

Socializing

9:00–9:30 · arrival outdoors

Goal. Help each child join play and make a choice without pressure to speak publicly.

Before children begin. Place the five choice cards at a low table near the arrival area; leave other familiar play materials accessible.

1. Greet the child by name. Offer two concrete play options already available.
2. If the child wants help joining peers, model: 'May I build with you?' Give peers time to respond.
3. Acknowledge the choice: 'You chose blocks today.' A child may point or begin playing instead of answering.
4. Near 10:00, give a two-minute warning, then guide cleanup and handwashing.

Teacher language: 'You can choose what you would like to try. We do not all have to choose the same thing.'

Children do: Choose, point, speak, or join an activity; practice an invitation or turn-taking when appropriate.

Notice: Can the child enter play with or without a prompt? Note support needed, not a pass/fail grade.

Co-teacher: Welcome new arrivals while the lead teacher supports a child who needs help joining play.

Materials: Five printed choice cards; existing blocks, books, paper, and outdoor movement space.

02

P.E.

9:30–9:40 · within the outdoor morning

Goal. Follow a simple movement sequence and notice personal space.

Before children begin. Choose a clear outdoor area with room to extend arms; no equipment is required.

1. Ask children to make 'airplane arms' and check that they are not touching a neighbor.
2. Model four slow movements: march eight steps; reach high four times; bend knees four times; balance on each foot for a short count.
3. Repeat the sequence once. Offer wall or adult support for balancing.
4. Finish with two slow breaths and walk to the next outdoor activity.

Teacher language: 'Find your own space. Move in a way that feels comfortable for your body.'

Children do: Follow or adapt the four movements.

Notice: Notices space around others and can switch movements with a cue.

Co-teacher: Model an accessible version beside children who need it; keep a clear path.

Materials: Open outdoor space; optional stable support for balance.

03

Large Circle

10:20–10:40

Goal. Express one preference and hear that classmates may choose differently.

Before children begin. Cut out and arrange the five printable choice cards in view; have the teacher display story ready for later.

1. Start with a brief welcome. Show READ, BUILD, DRAW, MOVE, and SOMETHING ELSE one at a time.
2. Model one genuine choice: 'I like to draw. I also like to try building.' Do not imply that one activity is best.
3. Invite children to choose by pointing, naming, or holding a card. Let children pass; return to them gently later.
4. Ask two contrasting questions: 'Did we all choose the same thing?' and 'What could we ask a friend about their choice?'
5. Close by showing the child page: 'You will circle one choice and draw what it looks like for you.'

Teacher language: 'My choice can be different from yours. We can listen to both.'

Children do: Point to or name a preference; listen while another child shares.

Notice: Can the child make a choice and attend to another child's response?

Co-teacher: Hold the cards where every child can see; offer a quieter pointing option for children who prefer it.

Materials: One teacher set of five choice cards (Child materials p.1); child page preview (p.2).

Hands-on work and reading

04

Practice / Small Group + STEM

10:40–11:10 · two 15-minute stations

Goal. Represent a preference on paper; count 1–5 concrete blocks one by one.

Before children begin. Print one My Choice page per child. Set crayons at each table. Put five blocks per participating child at the STEM station; have spare blocks available.

1. Station A, 10:40–10:55: model circling one pictured choice or the ‘something else’ option. Children then draw themselves doing it. Scribe a child’s words without correcting the choice.
2. Station B, 10:55–11:10: each child builds with up to five blocks. Teacher models touching one block for each number word. Invite the child to count their own structure.
3. Ask: ‘What did you make?’ and ‘How many blocks did you use?’ Offer a recount when fingers move faster than number words.
4. Record one brief observation per child. Clear materials together by 11:15.

Teacher language: ‘Touch one block when you say one number. Let’s see what you made.’

Children do: Circle and draw; build, touch-count 1–5, and describe or point to the structure.

Notice: One-to-one correspondence up to five; child’s own choice is represented, not copied from a neighbor.

Co-teacher: Lead or supervise the opposite station. If staffing is limited, run stations sequentially and reduce group size rather than leaving children without supervision.

Materials: My Choice worksheet (p.2), one per child; crayons; five blocks per child at the active station; observation sheet in teacher guide.

05

Book Time · before nap

12:40–13:00 · reading and settling

Goal. Listen to a short original story and notice that a character tries again.

Before children begin. Print one display copy of the four story pages; review the pictures and short text before lunch.

1. Show the cover of ‘Nia Tries Again.’ Say the title and let children notice the blocks.
2. Read each of the four pages slowly. Pause once after the tower falls: ‘What could Nia do next?’
3. At the end ask: ‘What did Nia and Eli like to do?’ Accept pointing to the pictures.
4. Put the story away and use the remaining part of the DOT window to settle for nap.

Teacher language: ‘Nia tried again. You can try again in your own way, too.’

Children do: Look, listen, predict or point, then prepare for rest.

Notice: Can the child point to or describe one event in the story?

Co-teacher: Support the settling routine while the lead teacher reads; do not treat the whole 20-minute window as reading time.

Materials: ‘Nia Tries Again,’ four printable story pages (Child materials pp.4–7), one teacher display set.

Revisit, review, create

07

Book Time · after nap

15:30–15:34 · proposed short revisit

Goal. Reconnect with a familiar story after waking.

Before children begin. Have the same teacher story copy at the circle.

1. Show the cover and one familiar picture; name the story briefly.
2. Re-read only the third story page (child PDF p.6), then ask: “What changed when Nia tried again?”
3. Move immediately into the Review / Small Circle questions.

Teacher language: ‘Let’s look again. What do you notice this time?’

Children do: Point to a picture or offer one observation.

Notice: Re-engages with a familiar book after nap.

Co-teacher: Help late wakers join quietly; do not extend this slot if the wake-up routine runs long.

Materials: Same teacher story copy; no extra printing. This four-minute placement is a prototype choice, not a separate DOT time slot.

06

Review / Small Circle

15:34–15:42 · within combined afternoon block

Goal. Recall an idea from the morning or the story and listen to a peer.

Before children begin. Keep two choice cards and the third story page (child PDF p.6) nearby.

1. Invite children to look at the story illustration. Ask what Nia did after the tower fell.
2. Show two choice cards and ask: ‘Can two friends like different things?’ Invite one or two responses.
3. Invite a child to show an action they tried today. Allow a gesture instead of speech.
4. Transition directly to the self-portrait activity.

Teacher language: ‘I heard two different choices. Both belong in our classroom.’

Children do: Recall, point, speak, gesture, or listen.

Notice: Can the child revisit one idea without needing an exact verbal answer?

Co-teacher: Invite quieter children with a card to point to; do not force a public turn.

Materials: Two choice cards and the third story page (child PDF p.6), already printed for earlier blocks.

Goal. Create a self-portrait that shows a chosen activity.

Before children begin. Print one portrait page per child. Put crayons, child-safe scissors, and glue sticks on the table. Pre-cut badges for children who need help.

1. Point to the large drawing frame: 'Draw yourself doing something you enjoy.' Model a stick person on scrap paper without giving a finished picture to copy.
2. Children choose one printed activity badge at the bottom, cut or receive it pre-cut, and glue it to the frame. 'Something else' remains available.
3. Invite each child to tell the teacher about the drawing. Write their words on the line if they want.
4. Display or file the work and clear the table by 16:00.

Teacher language: 'This is your picture. It can look different from mine or anyone else's.'

Children do: Draw, select a badge, cut or receive help, glue, and share if desired.

Notice: Child represents an idea of their own and uses tools with appropriate help.

Co-teacher: Support scissors and glue, help with cleanup, and keep one-to-one support available.

Materials: One Self-Portrait page (p.3) per child; crayons, child-safe scissors, glue sticks; optional pre-cut badge strips.

PREPARATION / OBSERVATION

Ready to teach

Print and supply checklist

TASK	ITEM	QUANTITY	OWNER / WHEN
Print	Five choice cards	1 teacher set · child PDF p.1	Lead teacher · Before Tuesday
Print	My Choice worksheet	1 per child + 2 spare · p.2	Lead teacher · Before Tuesday
Print	Self-Portrait page with badges	1 per child + 2 spare · p.3	Lead teacher · Before Tuesday
Print	Nia Tries Again story	1 teacher display set · pp.4–7	Lead teacher · Before Tuesday
Cut	Five choice cards	1 set	Lead teacher · Before arrival
Prepare	Pre-cut badges for children needing support	As needed, from portrait page	Co-teacher · Before afternoon art
Gather	Blocks	5 per child at active station + spare	Co-teacher · Before 10:40
Gather	Crayons, child-safe scissors, glue sticks	Enough for each active table	Co-teacher · Before each table block
Prepare	Clear movement space and table stations	1 area + 2 stations	Both teachers · Before children arrive

Brief observations

- ☐ Choice: point / name / gesture / pass — what support helped?
- ☐ Listening: notice a peer's different choice — independent / prompted / not yet observed.
- ☐ Counting: touch-count up to five — independent / prompted / not yet observed.
- ☐ Story: recall or point to the ‘try again’ moment — independent / prompted / not yet observed.

Editorial note

The weekly theme comes from the TE Curriculum Planner; Blue day windows come from Daily Operation Tasks. Internal time splits, method, original story, and child printables are a new prototype requiring pedagogical review. This file is not an administrator-approved weekly release.